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A Christmas QSO

BY Ibenezer SQrooge*

"IBENEZER SQrooge . . . Ibenezer SQrooge . . ."

"Who calls . . . QRZed?"

"Ibenezer SQrooge . . . this is the ghost of Old Times Past. We're going to take a little eyeball through the Good Old Days."

"QRX one, Old Timer. I don't want to eyeball nothing today."

"Come Ibenezer SQrooge. We go back . . . back . . . through the years. Look . . . look there . . ."

"Why that's my old home with my old zepp on the roof. And that's me up in the attic. And there's my old 3-tube receiver . . . and 10-watt breadboard rig . . . and look at them QSL cards on the wall."

"And what are you doing, I. SQrooge?"

"It's evening . . . oh, I remember. I'm on a traffic sked handling Christmas messages. But it was hard! Some nut threw a carrier on the net every night. Took us hours and hours to pass that traffic."

"And now what do you see, I. SQrooge?"

"Oh, this is later. I'm real excited. Must be working a new state . . . or new country. And there, I'm filling out a QSL card . . . and begging the other fella to please send me his card. And look, there I'm building a new rig. And all them other fellas around the shack . . . we were always helping each other, ya know, and . . ."

"And now . . . now where are you, Ibenezer SQrooge?"

"Lessee . . . why, that's on a hill. Ohhhhh, it's Field Day. I'm putting up the tents . . . climbing trees . . .trying to start that blasted generator. Great fun. I even did the cooking that year . . . and everybody got sick. But our club did pretty well . . ."

"And now, I. SQrooge, where are you?"

"Why that's the old radio club meeting. Fine times we had . . . then. Swapping parts . . . and lies about good DX. Oh, there I am taking notes. I was secretary . . . and I edited the club paper, too, and . . . yeah . . . I did everything in them days."

"Yes, Ibenezer SQrooge. You did your part . . . then. But what about now? What about this year? Let's look . . . let's eyeball this year."

"Naw, Old Timer, let's QRT for now. It's not good for my old eyes to look too close. Besides there's a good show on TV and . . ."

"Ibenezer SQrooge . . ."

"Please Old Timer, not . . . not this year . . . maybe some other year. Spare me this year . . . ohhhh . . . where are you taking me???? . . . oh me . . . I see . . . oh . . . That was last night when I was tuning my rig."

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"Correct. And on what frequency were you tuning your 10 kw.?"

"I . . . I don't remem . . . ahhh . . . I forget."

"You were zero beat with a net frequency. And you tuned your rig for about two hours, didn't you? That net was passing Christmas traffic. Why did you do that, I. SQrooge?"

"Ohhhh . . . well . . . well . . . that net was operating on *my* frequency . . ."

"*Your* frequency, Ibenezer SQrooge?"

"Well . . . ahh . . . yes. I monitor that frequency all the time. But when they come on with all their messages, I can't monitor my frequency. So, I have to protect my rights to my own channel . . . ahhhh . . . I mean . . . well, . . . suppose somebody wanted to call me???"

"Who would want to call *you*, I. SQrooge? That Christmas traffic was from a long way off . . . and it would be very comforting to all concerned if the messages were delivered. Don't you remember, I. SQrooge??? . . . when you used to handle . . ."

"Oh please, Old Timer . . . no more. I won't . . . really I won't do it again. They can use my frequency for their traffic in the evenings."

"*Your* frequency?"

"OK, Old Timer . . . I'll tune the whole band."

"And now, I. SQrooge . . . do you see all those people?"

"Who are they? Where are they? Ohhhh, that's Field Day someplace. Guess I don't know any of them fellas . . . Oh, maybe that gray haired fella yonder. But I wasn't there. Field Day's for young fellas."

"So instead you stayed home and had your own Field Day. Your score was how many QSOs you could disrupt."

"Yeah, but how is anybody gonna QSO anybody with them fellas all messing up the band

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with a contest? I have to defend my rights to a QSO, ya know."

"Remember waaaaaay back, I. SQrooge? Who sat up all night in the contests?"

"Well, that was different then, and . . ."

"Now, Ibenezer SQrooge . . . look at this room full of people. Know any of them?"

"Ahhhh . . . well, one or two, I guess. But they got a lot fatter since I last saw 'em. Yeah, that must be the club meeting."

"Where were you, I. SQrooge?"

"Ahhhh, I had real important business."

"You were home flat on your back watching TV."

"No more Old Timer . . . QRT . . . QRT, I say. I've had enough. I used to do all them good things. Build all my own gear . . . rag chew all day . . . handle traffic in the evenings, then sit up all night working DX . . . QSLs for everybody . . . and Field Days . . . and contests . . . and club meetings. I *used* to do all them things, Old Timer."

"And do you think your net . . . or your friends . . . or your club is any less deserving of your services and participation now than they used to be?"

"Well no . . . it's not that. I just been too busy. And besides . . . well, things is different . . ."

"The only difference is *you*, Ibenezer SQrooge. You always volunteered for all occasions. How many projects do you suppose have *not* been done because *you* did not offer your help?"

"Oh, I'll volunteer next time, Old Timer, really I will . . . I will . . . I will . . . I will . . . I . . . ahhhhh . . . ohhh . . . whatsammater? That you Marge? Whatcha looking at me like that for?"

"Last time you hollered 'I will' with that much enthusiasm, we were standing in front of a preacher."

"Yeah, oooooo . . . I must have had a real bad dream."

"You really were dreaming! Calling me Old Timer . . . calling a club meeting to order . . . volunteering to climb a tree!! You????? At your age??? Maybe you got a little problem! You feel OK?"

"Marge, never felt better. And I got no problems . . . at least not no more. But I can't tell ya all about it now . . . too much to do. What time is it? Ah, just in time for the net . . . haven't checked in for years. Might help out for a while. Lesseeeee . . . what's Charlie's number? I'll volunteer to work in the club booth at the County Fair next summer . . . and I'll help with the club paper . . . and I'll help next Field Day too . . . and Marge, I'll volunteer *you* to do the cooking. And I'll take them QSL cards out of the waste basket and answer 'em . . . and I'll clean up my TVI all over the neighborhood . . . and then I'll help them kids with their code practice. Then I'll give that new fella in town a hand with his antenna . . . I'll climb that tree for him so's to get in shape for Field Day . . . haw!"

"Maybe you better lie down again. Haven't seen you so stirred up in years."

"I'll explain later, Old Timer . . . errrr Old Marge . . . ahhhh . . . Marge, Old Girl. Too busy makin' up . . . I'm late for net check in. All I got time for right now is to say . . . Merrrrrrry Christmas! And I promise to make it a real Happy New Year . . . next year . . . for everybody." QST

NEW BOOKS

Fundamentals of Integrated Circuits (Motorola series), by Lothar Stern. Published by Hayden Book Company, Inc., 116 W. 14th St., New York, N. Y. 10011. 176 pages, well illustrated, cloth cover, 7 by 10 inches. Price, $8.95. Cat. No. 5695.

This informative book is written in a style that can be understood by those who do not have a formal education in electronics. Yet, it is presented with the technician and engineer in mind and is capable of imparting the basic integrated-circuit knowledge needed by electronics people at all levels of industry. Radio amateurs and experimenters should find this book as useful as do those who are at higher technical plateaus. It is refreshing to note the absence of the mathematical gymnastics which so often are a major factor in unraveling the sometimes-mysterious substance of modern-day technical books and engineering papers. One does not need to have a slide rule, Mathematics, or computer at hand to comprehend the data given by the author.

A generous sprinkling of schematic diagrams and artist's sketches illustrate the highlights of the text in all chapters of the book. This publication should not only serve as a primer in basic integrated-circuit techniques, but can be used as a refresher course by those who are already versed in this field.

The first four chapters furnish the reader a practical foundation for the material in the remaining chapters. Chapter 1 outlines the basic physical concepts of ICs and introduces most of common terms of the integrated-circuit language. Chapters 2, 3, and 4 deal with basic semiconductor theory — junctions, holes, resistivity, capacitance, transistor types, electrical functions, and other important considerations.

Chapters 5 through 8 cover the actual mechanics involved in the design and fabrication of various types of ICs — thin-film circuits, resistive and capacitive elements of ICs, multi-chip designs, reliability considerations, and the many packaging methods used when building integrated circuits. Chapter 9 treats many of the popular circuit applications for ICs and includes schematic diagrams of the circuits discussed. Several curves are included to show the transfer characteristics of the integrated circuits. Among the circuits discussed are differential and operational amplifiers, r.f. and i.f. amplifiers, audio and video amplifiers, and others. Stabilization is also a topic in this section of the book.

The balance of the book covers practical design techniques — initial design considerations, what can be integrated, packaging, breadboarding and testing, design examples, and other useful data. In giving an overall appraisal of this book, it appears to be one of the most complete texts on basic integrated circuits and their applications that has been published. It should make a valuable addition to any electronics man's technical library. It tells a plain-language story about ICs, from the ground up — W1CER.